

Kuda 3.0

Confidence Layer

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Senior product proposal for transaction confidence, service recovery and money-state clarity.

PRODUCT THESIS

Kuda 3.0 has largely solved the old discoverability problem. The next product advantage is confidence: money states, exception journeys, support ownership and recurring commitments should be clear enough that customers do not have to chase the app for answers.

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Independent concept based on public product observations and prior teardown work. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Kuda.

01 / DOCUMENT PURPOSE

Document Purpose

This PRD converts the August 2026 Kuda 3.0 teardown into an executable product definition. It does not propose another information-architecture redesign. It focuses on the moments where customers need certainty: a transfer is delayed, a balance changes, support is needed, a repayment is due, a recurring debit is approaching, or search needs to explain the customer's own money.

SCOPE BOUNDARY

This is an independent concept proposal. It assumes no access to Kuda internal data, architecture or commercial priorities. All targets and sequencing are hypotheses to validate through research, analytics and technical discovery.

02 / PRODUCT CONTEXT

Product Context

Kuda 3.0 already improves findability through a cleaner home, global search, visible support, dedicated Save/Invest/Borrow destinations and consolidated account actions. The product baseline also includes transaction status, editable categories, budgeting, Direct Debit, security controls and a clearer overdraft experience. This PRD therefore deepens these capabilities instead of duplicating them.

Previous proposal area	Current baseline	PRD direction
Dashboard personalization	Cleaner Kuda 3.0 home with stronger action access	One contextual priority rail; privacy-aware and conservative
Transaction search	Global search + transaction status/categories	Read-only semantic financial retrieval backed by deterministic data
Failed transaction recovery	Real-time status + retry/reversal logic	Resolution timeline, ownership, ETA/checkpoints, contextual escalation
Security centre	Passkeys, Safety Mode, Private Mode, card controls	Consolidate posture/recovery; explain states instead of duplicating controls
Bills/subscriptions	Bills + Direct Debit mandates	Recurring Money Hub covering confirmed commitments and detected patterns

03 / PROBLEM STATEMENT

Problem Statement

The core problem is not that customers cannot find features. It is that important financial states can still require interpretation. In high-anxiety moments, a status label is not enough. Customers need to know what is true, who owns the next action, what they can safely do, and when they should expect another update.

- Exception states can be technically accurate without being operationally clear to the customer.
- Support can be visible without inheriting the context of the product journey that created the problem.
- Balances, pending amounts, savings, investments and overdraft availability can be individually correct yet difficult to reconcile mentally.
- Recurring commitments are spread across bills, Direct Debit, savings and credit behaviours instead of one planning view.
- Global search solves navigation; it does not yet answer bounded questions about the customer's own financial history.

04 / PRODUCT GOAL & NON-GOALS

Product Goal & Non-Goals

Goal	Outcome
Make exception journeys self-explanatory	Customers understand state, ownership and next checkpoint without repeated retries or support contact.
Reduce effort in service recovery	Support begins with product context and visible case ownership.
Create coherent money-state language	Every customer-facing amount has a source, freshness rule and availability meaning.
Add intelligence carefully	Personalization and semantic search are constrained, explainable and reversible.
Improve recurring-money visibility	Confirmed mandates and inferred patterns are separated and understandable.

Non-goals

- No second full home-screen or navigation redesign in the first 90 days.
- No unbounded conversational financial guidance that can invent amounts or act outside existing secure flows.
- No duplication of security controls that already exist.
- No prediction presented as posted or reserved financial truth.
- No direct use of live Kuda customer data or credentials in concept validation artifacts.

05 / TARGET USERS & JOBS TO BE DONE

Target Users & Jobs To Be Done

User situation	Job to be done	Current anxiety
High-frequency transfer user	Understand whether a delayed transfer is safe and what happens next	Repeated retries, duplicate payments, support chasing
Salary earner / budgeter	Know how much is genuinely available to spend	Conflicting mental model across pending, savings and credit
Customer with recurring bills	See what is expected to leave the account and what is confirmed	Missed obligations and confusion between mandates vs predictions
Customer needing support	Continue a product issue into support without starting over	Repetition, duplicate cases, low sense of ownership
Power user searching history	Ask bounded questions about own transactions	Manual filters, reformulation, difficulty retrieving old activity

06 / EXPERIENCE PRINCIPLES

Experience Principles

- Ledger is financial truth. No customer-facing interface may invent balances, recipients or terminal transaction states.
- State before copy. Define canonical states and transitions first; copy explains them.
- Events keep app, notifications, support and incident surfaces synchronized.
- Derived data is labelled. Forecasts and detected subscriptions remain visibly different from posted or reserved money.
- Privacy actions propagate immediately enough to be trusted.

- Recovery operations are idempotent to avoid duplicate retries, cases or reminders.
- Natural-language interpretation is limited to intent recognition and summarization; deterministic services compute all financial answers.
- Instrumentation ships with the feature, not after launch.

07 / FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

Functional Requirements

7.1 Transaction Confidence & Resolution (P0)

- Expose a customer-facing timeline: Initiated -> Sent -> Network/Bank response -> Completed, Reversed or Under Review.
- Show plain-language ownership for every exception state, including whether Kuda, the receiving bank/rail, or the customer owns the next action.
- Show an ETA band only where confidence is sufficient; otherwise show the next checkpoint.
- Automatically escalate when a configured recovery window is breached.
- Attach case history to the originating transaction and surface known incidents in context.
- Suppress duplicate notifications and duplicate case creation.

7.2 Contextual Support & Incident Recovery (P1)

- Provide "Get help with this..." entry points from transfer, overdraft and account-access objects.
- Pass a secure context envelope containing allowed object identifiers, customer-safe state, timestamps, error class, incident correlation ID and completed self-service steps.
- Show case states in Inbox: Open, Awaiting Partner, Action Needed, Resolved.
- Offer "follow this case" when an existing case already covers the same object.
- Use asynchronous support or callback for non-urgent cases to reduce live-chat waiting.

7.3 Money-State Reliability (P1)

- Define Current Balance, Available to Spend, Pending/Reserved, Savings, Investment Available/Unsettled, Borrowed Amount, Minimum Repayment and Repayment Due.
- Every money value must have a documented source, freshness rule and display label.
- Explain material differences inline, including settlement and freshness context.
- Budget calculations must use the same categorized transaction source as history and statements.
- Overdraft repayment must show received -> applied -> available-credit refreshed state transitions.

7.4 Contextual Home (P1 pilot)

- Show no more than one primary contextual priority card at a time.
- Prioritize risk, obligation or unresolved money events above promotional content.
- Respect privacy preferences across preview surfaces.
- Allow Pin, Hide, Mute and "Why am I seeing this?" controls without deep settings.
- Keep core Send and Pay actions stable.

7.5 Search 2.0 (P1 pilot)

- Support natural-language retrieval over the customer's own transactions and product navigation.
- Separate intent interpretation from deterministic financial computation.
- Expose the source transactions used for any financial summary.
- Route action requests to the existing secure product flow rather than executing money movement from search.
- Use a safe fallback when query confidence is low.

7.6 Recurring Money Hub (P1 prototype)

- Combine confirmed Direct Debit mandates, Kuda bills/reminders, scheduled savings debits and known loan/overdraft repayments in one calendar.
- Visually distinguish confirmed commitments from detected recurring patterns.
- Allow customers to confirm, correct or dismiss detected items.

- Show projected available-to-spend only as derived information, using ranges or confidence where amounts vary.
- Explain cancellation ownership accurately when the external provider must cancel a mandate or subscription.

08 / ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

Acceptance Criteria

Capability	Minimum acceptance criteria
Transaction resolution	No UI terminal state without payment/ledger confirmation; every exception has one explanation + one next step.
Support handoff	Contextual support passes a secure reference; customers can see case state without reopening chat.
Money-state	Pending/reserved funds never silently appear as available-to-spend; freshness can be explained.
Home	Maximum one priority card; privacy preferences respected; customers can hide/mute without deep settings.
Search	Financial totals are computed deterministically; source transactions are inspectable; low-confidence fallback exists.
Recurring Money	Confirmed mandates and inferred patterns are visually distinct; forecasts never reduce ledger balance.

09 / TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

Technical Requirements

Area	Requirement
State model	Canonical transaction and money-state contracts owned by payment/ledger domains.
Events	Durable material-state events for app, notification, support and incident consumers.
Idempotency	Retries, escalation, case creation and notifications must be duplicate-safe.
Search	Permission-scoped transaction index; intent interpretation separated from deterministic financial computation.
Support	RBAC-aware context envelope, redaction and audit log for agent-visible data.
Recurring	Mandate registry sourced from actual Direct Debit state; inferred patterns stored separately with confidence/evidence.
Observability	State dwell, retry count, reconciliation mismatch, case handoffs, semantic fallbacks and notification outcomes instrumented.

10 / ANALYTICS & SUCCESS MEASURES

Analytics & Success Measures

Outcome	Primary measures
Payment confidence	Contact rate per delayed/failed transaction; repeat transfer attempts; exception CSAT; self-service resolution.
Support continuity	First-contact resolution; duplicate-ticket rate; customer effort score; time to meaningful update.
Money-state trust	Discrepancy reports; state-freshness SLA; budget reconciliation accuracy; overdraft refresh time.
Home relevance	Time-to-action; priority-card action rate; dismiss/hide rate; privacy-control adoption.
Search reliability	Search success; reformulation; retrieval time; category correction; low-confidence fallback rate.
Recurring planning	Confirmed-item rate; reminder conversion; false-positive dismissal; forecast comprehension.

11 / DEPENDENCIES

Dependencies

- Payment/ledger state ownership and event publication.
- Incident/status service with machine-readable service impact.
- Support platform integration and permissions model.
- Shared money-state taxonomy across wallet, savings, investment and lending.
- Transaction metadata quality and search indexing.
- Direct Debit mandate state and recurring-pattern data discovery.
- Privacy/preference service with rapid cross-surface propagation.

12 / RISKS & GUARDRAILS

Risks & Guardrails

Risk	Guardrail
False ETA / misleading certainty	Use state-backed SLA bands and checkpoints; never guess.
Semantic interpretation error	Deterministic computation, inspectable source records and low-confidence fallback.
State divergence	Shared taxonomy, freshness metadata and reconciliation monitors.
Support data oversharing	Minimal context envelope, RBAC, audit logs and redaction.
Over-personalization	One-card limit, conservative eligibility and explicit controls.
Recurring false positives	Customer confirmation, confidence thresholds and editable/dismissible items.
Post-redesign fatigue	Incremental changes; no broad information-architecture change in first 90 days.

13 / ROLLOUT STRATEGY

Rollout Strategy

Phase	Focus
0-30 days	Instrument exception journeys; define state taxonomy; map support drivers; inventory recurring/search data.
31-60 days	Ship transaction timeline, contextual support, state-freshness explanations and incident integration.
61-90 days	Pilot contextual home card, bounded semantic search and mandate-first recurring-money calendar.

14 / DEFINITION OF DONE

Definition of Done

- Customer-facing state and ownership copy approved by Product, Support, Risk and Legal/Compliance where required.
- Canonical state contracts documented and consumed by all relevant surfaces.
- Analytics events verified in staging and dashboards defined before rollout.
- Usability testing shows customers can correctly explain what happened, what they can do next and when to expect an update.
- Feature flags support gradual rollout and rapid rollback.
- Concept-validation artifacts use synthetic data and never request or store live customer banking credentials.